



7.1 What is a settlement?

Look around the city, town or village in which you live. Compare it with the below figures. You will find that the buildings, roads, drains etc. are organised in some way. This arrangement varies widely across the world as we shall see now.

The way we organise ourselves and our living spaces in a place is called a settlement – that is, the geographic space where we live and work. In a settlement, we have different kinds of activities – Educational, Medical, Religious, Commercial etc.

In this chapter, we will take a brief look at some aspects of human settlement and the geography related to it.

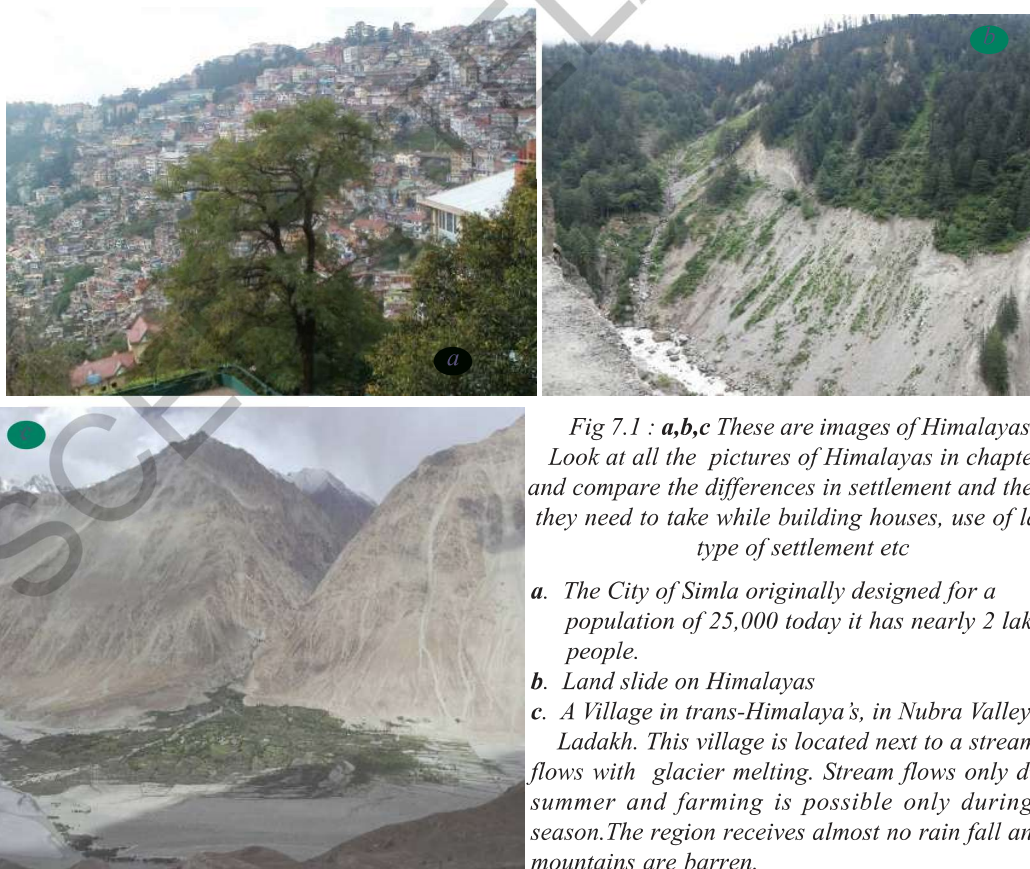


Fig 7.1 : a,b,c These are images of Himalayas. Look at all the pictures of Himalayas in chapter-1 and compare the differences in settlement and the risk they need to take while building houses, use of land, type of settlement etc

- a.** The City of Simla originally designed for a population of 25,000 today it has nearly 2 lakh people.
- b.** Land slide on Himalayas
- c.** A Village in trans-Himalaya's, in Nubra Valley of Ladakh. This village is located next to a stream that flows with glacier melting. Stream flows only during summer and farming is possible only during this season. The region receives almost no rain fall and the mountains are barren.

Field work

Look at your own city, town or village. Draw a sketch map of a selected area using the methods you had learnt earlier. Your map should show the following:

Roads, Houses, Shops and markets, Streams and drains, some Public places like hospitals, schools, bus stand, railway station etc;

- Are the public places located at points that would be convenient to most people?
- Do you find any patterns in the location of markets?
- Are the houses in clusters? Are they linked to the main road?

Talk to people in the selected area and find out the changes in the settlement during the past twenty years and the reasons for this.

What amenities should have been provided for, but have not been done?

7.2 How were settlements begun?

For about 1.8 lakh years, early humans lived in bands as hunter-gatherer. They did not practice agriculture. However owing to changes in ways of obtaining food, some bands took to the deliberate method of production of food - agriculture. As agriculturalists, they were increasingly sedentary (staying in one place).

Fig 7. 2 : A rockshelter used by early humans at Bhimbetka, Madhya Pradesh. Read the Chapter on hunter gatherers from class VI for details.



Table : 1



Compare and contrast : Using the information given above, compare and contrast nomadic and sedentary life styles. How many points could you identify? (Make another table if this space is not enough.)

Nomadic life style	Sedentary life style

7.3 Why do settlements change?

Settlements change for many reasons. Read the following story about Delhi.

The city of Delhi can claim to have been central to many empires that ruled India. When India gained independence, the city remained its capital. Over the decades, the city has attracted people from all parts of India as they migrated in search of livelihood, jobs, education, dispensary etc. As the capital of the country, with the Parliament and Central Government offices, there are people from all parts living in the city. Because of this, the population increased, i.e. more than two times.



Fig 7. 3 : A middle class housing colony.

Every city usually has a master plan to design and allocate different types of areas. In any city, there should be housing areas, markets, schools, industrial areas, office areas, parks and recreational areas and so on. Based on this, planners can decide the types of roads, the amount of water or electricity required, how to dispose waste, how to clean sewage etc that would be necessary. The city of Delhi had three such master plans. However, if we look at the current scenario, it would appear that these plans have not been implemented properly. In fact, Delhi has grown in an unplanned manner. A planned colony usually has all the facilities in place. Government has to announce areas demarcated for different purposes. The constructions in that area are expected to follow such an order. However, it is clear that such plans have not been followed.

On one hand, there is growing population in the cities and on the other hand, there is long delay in planning and announcing how the areas are to be used. People who migrate to the city looking for work, occupy land and settles, often without necessary permission and build on it in the way they can afford with no help or facility from anyone. They remain unauthorised for long periods. When the plan is finally announced, these areas may be marked for a different purpose.

This leads to a difficult conflict situation. People face constant threat of eviction. They seek political patronage from being evicted from their homes. These colonies are not likely to be recognised because the master plan ignored their existence. Thus these colonies also do not receive many public amenities. People here are poor but they have built the city and continue to provide essential services to the city.

7.4 What type of places are formed as settlements?

To understand this, we need to look at these basic concepts: (1) site (2) situation (3) the history of the place.



Fig 7.4 : Fort in Pratapgad

Site refers to the characteristics of the place – its topography, altitude, characteristics of water bodies like lakes, rivers, underground water, types of soils, security, shelter from natural forces, and so on.

In early settlement periods, places which had favourable water supply and good protection from invasions were preferred. For example, Chhatrapati Shivaji built a fort in Pratapgadh, Maharashtra.

This site was chosen because of its altitude from where all the surrounding areas could be seen. This provided military security.

Places do not exist in isolation. They are in some way connected to other places. Situation describes the connections with other places. For example: Visakhapatnam is located on the coast and connects to many places in and outside of India.

Over the decades, Visakhapatnam's population has grown significantly (see next table 2). This growth is a result of the importance of Visakhapatnam as a port city. This population increase also indicates growth in economic and social opportunities.

Visakhapatnam has a long history. It was ruled by different dynasties during pre-

colonial times. During the 19th century, the British and French fought a naval battle over this city. Coastal places were of immense significance for colonial powers because they could build ports there. These ports would enable export of raw materials to the colonising country.



Fig 7.5 : Visakhapatnam

In fact, cities such as Mumbai and Chennai were further developed by the colonial powers to better exploit the natural resources of India. The fight for Visakhapatnam was for similar reasons.

Table 2		
Population of Visakhapatnam		
Year	Population	%change
1901	40,892	
1911	43,414	+6.2%
1921	44,711	+3.0%
1931	57,303	+28.2%
1941	70,243	+22.6%
1951	1,08,042	+53.8%
1961	2,11,190	+95.5%
1971	3,63,467	+72.1%
1981	6,03,630	+66.1%
1991	7,52,031	+24.6%
2001	13,45,938	+78.97%
2011	20,35,690	+51.2%

Population change in Visakhapatnam :

1. In the population data given in the table, are the percentages reported for every decade? If not, which decade's data is not reported here?
2. From which decade to which decade has the population increase been the highest (in percentage)?
3. From which decade to which decade has the population increase been the lowest (in percentage)?
4. Plot the absolute population of Visakhapatnam on a line graph covering 1901-2011. What observations can you make about the changes in the absolute population size?

7.5 Indian settlements in hierarchy

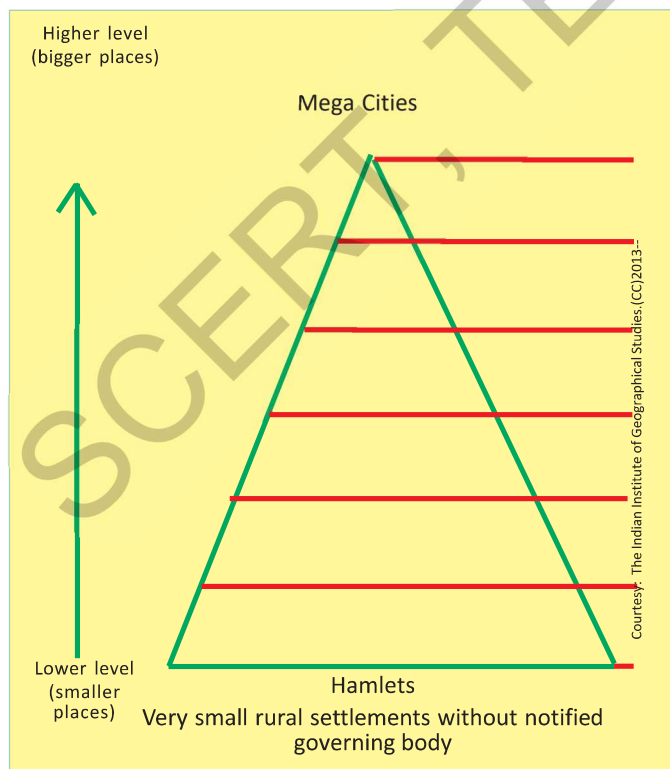
The Census of India organises settlements in India using certain criteria. In the Table 3, the Census department's definitions of various settlement types are given. Read them carefully and complete the exercise.

A pyramid is given in the next page. The bottom-most part of the pyramid shows the lowest level of the settlement hierarchy according to the Indian census. The top-most shows the highest level. Fill in the details that are left blank:

1. The name given to the particular level of settlement (Two examples are shown).
2. Give one example of a settlement from Telangana. (Other than mega cities, why?)
3. Try to place the town where you live (if you live in a village, show the nearest town) at the correct level, give 1 or 2 reasons for your choice.

Table 3 : Indian settlements in hierarchy

Settlement type	Criteria used	Examples
Mega Cities	Cities having more than 10 million people	* Greater Mumbai UA (population 18.4 million) * Delhi UA (population 16.3 million) * Kolkata UA (population 14.1 million).
Metropolitan Cities / Million Plus cities	Cities having population between one million and 10 million	* Chennai (8.6 million) * Hyderabad (7.2 million) * Ahmedabad (6.2 million)
Cities/ Class 1 cities	Urban areas having population between 1 lakh and one million	With the help of your teacher identify 2 cities and give the details of population within Telangana
Towns	All the urban areas having population between 5000 and 1 lakh	With the help of your teacher identify 3 towns in / nearby your area and give the details of population
Revenue / Census Village	A village with defined borders	With the help of your teacher identify 3 revenue villages in / nearby your area and give the details of population
Hamlets	A group of houses within the revenue village	With the help of your teacher identify one or two in a revenue villages in / nearby your area



4. Do you think settlements should be classified only on the basis of population? Can you think of any other way? Discuss with your teacher and identify the criteria for such classification.

In the future, India is poised to follow the trend of many ‘economically developed’ nations in becoming predominantly urban.

7.6 Urbanisation in India

In India, nearly 350 million i.e. one-third of population lives in cities and towns. People have been increasingly taking up non agriculture work and living in cities and towns. This process is called urbanisation. A considerable section of population in the 1950s lived in 5.6 lakh villages and there were only 5 cities that had a population of more than 1 million each and the number of cities with 1 lakh population was around 40. As per 2011 census, the number of villages has increased to 6.4 lakhs and about 850 million people live in these villages. Three cities – Mumbai, Delhi and Kolkata - accommodate more than 10 million people each. There are more than 50 cities that have a population of 1 million and above.

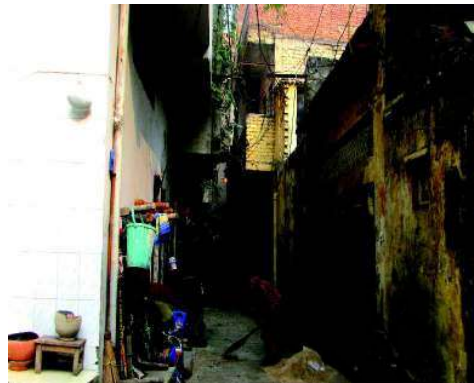


Fig 7.6 : Residential area of Low income people in Delhi

Though there has been an increase in urbanisation, the basic infrastructure that can support this growth is grossly insufficient. You require roads, drainage, electricity, water and other public facilities. Government intervention is making some headway in improving the urban infrastructure particularly those associated with road transport. However, the provision of electricity, water and health infrastructure is not sufficient. For poorer people in the cities and towns, this situation is even worse.

How does urban India contribute to India's economic development? Service sector activities such as information technology, finance, insurance, real estate and business related service activities such as transport, storage and communication contribute more than industrial activities. There is no major growth of industrial output over the last few decades. Most of the output comes from service activities.

Living in or moving into cities and towns is a boon only for a few. Although the level of poverty in urban areas is relatively lower than what is noticed in rural areas, there is a huge gap between the average income of a low income family and a high income family. This gap has also been increasing in cities and towns. Incomes earned in urban areas by the SC/ STs are far lower than other caste groups. In 2009-10, only about one-sixth of urbanites belonging to castes other than SC/ STs were poor whereas in the case of SC/ ST urbanites the poverty level is double. Most of these poor live in non metropolitan towns and work in the unorganised sector.

Most of the population increase in cities and towns took place as a consequence of natural growth within the urban areas. The population of these urban areas increased over time. Some of the growth in urban settlements took place by expansion, with the inclusion of rural areas surrounding older cities and towns. Only one-fifth of the growth is due to rural - to - urban migration.

7.6.1 Problems of Urbanisation

Increasing urbanisation is not just all about greater opportunities for people, more economic productivity, etc. It also results in many problems. The growing urban population has to be housed. It needs water supply, sewage and other waste disposal, transportation and many other things. All these result in environmental stress. As vehicle use increases, urban air pollution increases, causing health problems and localised climatic change. Improper sewage disposal can also lead to greater threat of infectious diseases.

One of the impacts of increased urbanisation is the use of materials that either do not degrade or take a long time to do so. This produces waste that has to be disposed off. Where do we put such waste? As urban areas expand, the waste is increasingly pushed to rural areas where they are either just dumped or taken to waste treatment plants.

7.6.2 Aerotropolis

A new kind of settlement is happening in many countries, including India. These settlements are centered around large airports. Hence, the name aerotropolis or airport city.

In an aerotropolis, the airport functions as a city in its own right. Many facilities like hotels, shopping, entertainment, food, business conferencing etc, are provided right there. People can fly in, conduct their business with their counterparts right there and fly out with all the comforts of a city, without the traffic and other problems.



- What is the centre of an aerotropolis?
- Name any two facilities located at or near the centre of an aerotropolis.
- On an outline map of the world, locate and label the cities given here in the examples. Name the country and the airport also on the map. Remember to use different types of text to identify the names of the country and the names of the cities and airports, so that it will be easier to see which words are names of countries, and which are for cities and their airports.
- Suppose that the place you have studied about in this chapter gets an aerotropolis near it. Mention 3 ways in which the site features of your place may change. Similarly, mention 3 ways in which the situation features of your place may change.

Some form of aerotropolises are emerging in these places in India: Kempegouda International Airport (Bengaluru), Indira Gandhi International Airport (Delhi), and Rajiv Gandhi International Airport (Hyderabad).

Elsewhere, examples of emerging aerotropolises include: Suvarnabhumi International Airport (Bangkok, Thailand), Dubai International Airport (Dubai, UAE), Cairo International Airport (Cairo, Egypt), and London Heathrow Airport (London, UK).

In India, the history and geographical features are a reason for expansion of a settlement and migration of people is another reason.

7.7 Migration

People moving from their places to other places in search of better opportunities is called migrations. Migration arises out of various social, economic or political reasons.



Activity

Measure and classify migration patterns

For identifying a person as a migrant, two criteria are used by the census:

- ♣ “birth place” – place where the person was born
- ♣ “last usual place of residence” – a place where the person had stayed continuously for a period of six months or more
- Here is a list of a few people. Categorise them as migrant or non-migrant. Indicate the pattern and guess the probable reasons for migration.

Name	Present address for the last six months	Place of birth	Migrant or non-migrant	Pattern of migration, rural to urban; urban to urban etc and possible reason
Sindhu	Bijwaram	Village in Jogulamba Dt.		
Grace Oviya	Hyderabad	Mumbai		
Ali (an NRI)	New Delhi	London		
Lakshmi	Thimmapur (for only two months)	Ranga Reddy Dt.		
Swathi	Manakondur Karimnagar Dt.	Hyderabad		Selected for Group IV TSPSC

In India, according to census 2011, about 307 million people have been reported as migrants. Migrations can happen due to many reasons. While females report marriage as the most common reason for migration, employment or seeking employment is the most common reason for males to migrate. Dissatisfaction with employment opportunities in the native place, better opportunity for studies, losses in business, family feuds etc are also some of the other reasons that people have stated as reasons for migration in the census surveys.



Do you agree with “Most of the children are dropouts in migrant families”. Explain with examples related to your area.

7.7.1 Seasonal and Temporary Migration

According to the national census surveys, every fourth person in India is a migrant. During 2001-2011, migration increased but not as much as in the 1980s. This may be within a state or outside. We have examined the statistics of rural – urban migration and the multiple reasons for migration. However, it is significant to note that rural to rural migration is increased. Some of this may not be captured by census data because the period of stay is often less than six months. The number of seasonal migrants is underestimated in India due to limitations in the definition of the term ‘migrant’ used in the national surveys.

7.7.2 Rural to Rural migration

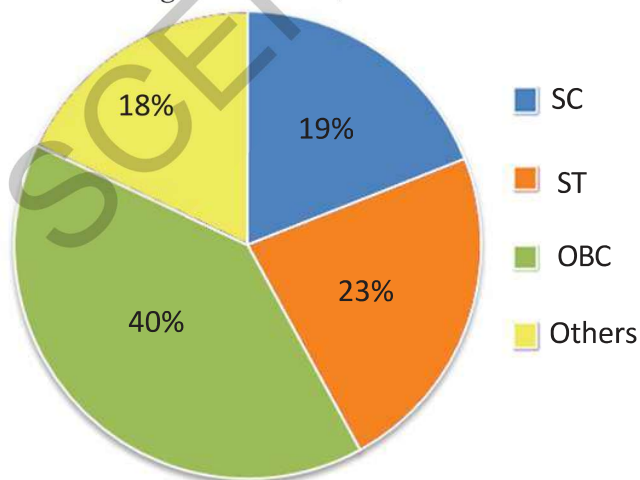
Maharashtra is one of the popular states of India which produces sugar. It has 186 cooperative sugar factories. Large scale sugarcane cultivation began here in the early 1970s after the Koina dam was built. A study estimates that about 6,50,000 labourers migrate from central to western Maharashtra for sugarcane cutting each year. Of these, around 2,00,000 are children in the school age group of 6-14 years. They come with their family members.

The sugarcane cutters camp for the season in clearings earmarked by factories. These are in the vicinity of the fields. Each family is provided with a bamboo mat and poles.

A large section of rural workers migrate for a short duration and particularly due to distress caused in rural areas. They are mainly agricultural labourers or marginal farmers in their place of origin and mostly belong to low income households, dalits and adivasis.

The National Commission of Rural Labour in its report in 1990s found that uneven development and regional disparity triggered and accelerated seasonal migration. In some tribal areas, intrusion of outsiders and displacement of people for construction of dams and mining have increased distress seasonal migration.

Pie Chart 1 : Social Background of short term migrants in India, 2007-08



In agriculture sector, employers go to the native place of migrants and recruit them. Contractors (also called agents), traders who belong to the same caste, community or source area are used by employers of quarries in Delhi, coffee plantations of Karnataka, and farming in Punjab. Such workers come with workers who have already migrated. Contractors retain part of the migrants earnings apart from the payments they receive from employers. Sometimes, the contractors also work as supervisors.

7.7.3 Rural to Urban migration

People migrate from rural areas mainly due to insufficient employment opportunities and inadequate income available in rural employment. People also migrate with the expectation of higher income and more opportunities for family members and may be better services. Most urban migrants have to work as labourers and find employment in the unorganised sector. They could be working as hawkers, painters, repair persons, rickshaw pullers, construction labour etc.



When people move out of rural areas, which sector of the economy in the rural area loses the most number of people? Why?

- In urban areas, what are the common sector(s) of the economy in which migrants from the rural areas find employment? What are the reasons for this?

People from rural areas, move to cities and towns to work in industry and other service activities. This has been recognised as a natural reason to increase their income and for better family prospects. In this process, they have opportunities for education, new jobs and to acquire new skills. Towns also appear to offer greater freedom and somewhat less discrimination based on caste and gender. However, many move to urban areas more out of desperation and not having adequate employment opportunities in the rural areas. For these people, living conditions in slums in towns and cities are worse because space is cramped and even basic facilities such as drinking water and sanitation aren't available. These people are not able to find jobs in the 'organised sector' and therefore there is no job security and decent income that they were aspiring for. They continue to live as daily workers.

Many families have residences both at their origin (native place) and at the destination. They shift between the two places depending on work and seasons. Migration does not necessarily involve movement of all members of the family, and often the wife remains in the rural area.

Urban migrants use different job searching mechanisms depending upon their skills and educational qualifications. Contacts and networks are crucial for getting urban jobs. In fact, villagers pre-arrange their jobs from rural areas and come to urban areas through their contacts or networks. They keep close ties with their rural areas for a variety of reasons.



● Interview a person who has come to a town to work in the unorganised sector as a labourer or domestic servant and write her story

- If you live in a rural area, interview a person who has come on a vacation from working in a town in the unorganised sector, write his story
- Compare and contrast these two situations.

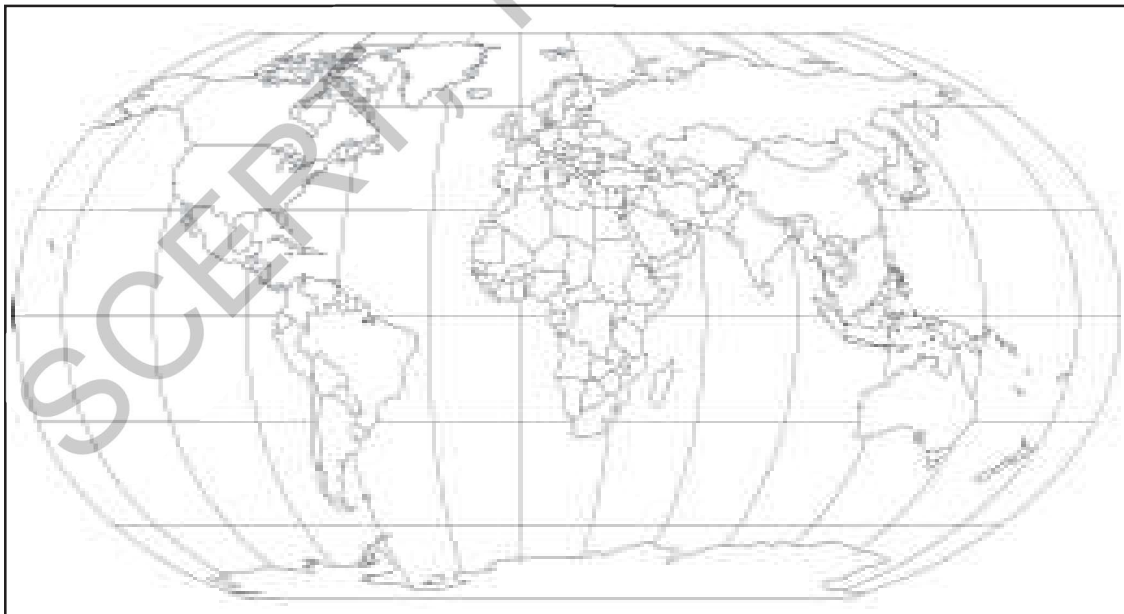
Migrants also pass on the urban opportunities to the rural areas so that potential migrants can engage in rural-based job search. In most cases, migration is the survival strategy for many families.

7.7.4 International migration

One-third of the world's 200 million international migrants, less than 70 million people, according to the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), have moved from one developing country to another. International migration from India is of two types:

People with technical skills and professional expertise have migrated to countries such as USA, Canada, United Kingdom, Australia and other developed countries. IT professionals, doctors and management professionals are an example of this type. Indians migrating to countries such as UK and Canada in 1950s and 1960s were unskilled whereas in the later years, mostly professionals went to these countries. In recent times, Indian professionals also go to countries such as Germany, Norway, Japan and Malaysia. In the 1950s, about 10,000 persons a year went to developed countries and in 1990s, this has increased to more than 60,000 a year.

The second type of international migration is unskilled and semi-skilled workers migrating to oil exporting countries of the West Asia on temporary contracts. Almost all these workers come back after a specific period depending on the employment situation in the destination countries. During the last few decades, Saudi Arabia and UAE (United Arab Emirates) have been the important destinations for most of the 3 million Indian workers in the West Asia.



Draw arrow lines on the World Map depicting people from India going to different countries mentioned in the above passages.

Every year, more than 3 lakh workers migrate to West Asia. Nearly three-fifths of workers going to West Asia are from Kerala, Tamil Nadu Telangana and Andhra Pradesh. A considerable section of these workers are engaged in construction projects, maintenance, services, transport and telecommunications.

7.8 What happens when people migrate?

“Migrants who are unskilled and perform manual labor often face many hardships in their countries of work. They spend more on food as they cannot get food grains from fair price shops at their workplaces.”. As they live in harsh circumstances and unhygienic conditions, they suffer from health problems and are prone to disease. Those working in quarries, brick kilns, construction sites and mines suffer from body ache, sun stroke, skin irritation and lung diseases. When employers do not follow safety measures, accidents in industrial areas and construction sites are also common. Migrants are not able to access various health and family care programmes as they do not belong to the organised sector. In the case of women migrant workers, there is no maternity leave. This means they have to go back to work soon after childbirth.

When families migrate, children accompanying their parents do not have creche facilities. Grown up children are not able to continue their studies at their parents’ new workplaces. Schools in their native place refuse to take them again when they come back. They finally become dropouts. When males leave their families, it is also a major challenge for women who have to take care of all the responsibilities of the family and elderly people who need care. Young girls in such families are required to take care of siblings and many of them become dropouts.

Migration leaves a considerable mark on the migrants also. Exposure to different environment, stress associated with it, food available and social atmosphere leave a deep impact on migrants. This also depends on the length of migration.

Most migrants and particularly those going for a long term send remittances. In some regions of India, nearly one-third of households depend on the remittances sent by their migrant members. Majority of seasonal migrants either remit or



- What can be done so that migrants are able to get access to food, health and family care programmes?
- There are some initiatives taken by government and voluntary agencies. Find out if there is any such initiative in your area. Invite some persons from such agencies to talk in the school.

bring back savings. Migration allows households to meet debts and other obligations without having to sell assets. It is also common to find migrant families buying house, land, agricultural machinery and consumer durables. Some migrants might take up jobs in the destination, acquire skills required in the destination area, become aware of how to get regular jobs and migrate regularly or permanently.

7.9 Monitoring of International Migration

The Emigration Act, 1983 is the Indian law governing migration and employment of Indians abroad. It also lays out conditions to safeguard the interests of workers emigrating for employment. Embassies set up by the Indian Government in different countries are expected to follow the legal procedures and protect the welfare of the international migrants as given in the Emigration Act. At times, migrant workers are not paid their salaries, recruitment agents cheat prospective workers or collect more than the prescribed fees for their role in getting work for workers abroad. Employers also terminate the job contract before its expiry, change the employment contract to the disadvantage of migrant workers, pay less than the agreed salary and freeze fringe benefits and other perks. They often force workers to do overtime without making additional payments, and deny permission to keep one's own passport. Indian migrant workers seldom lodge any complaint against their foreign employers for the fear of losing their jobs.

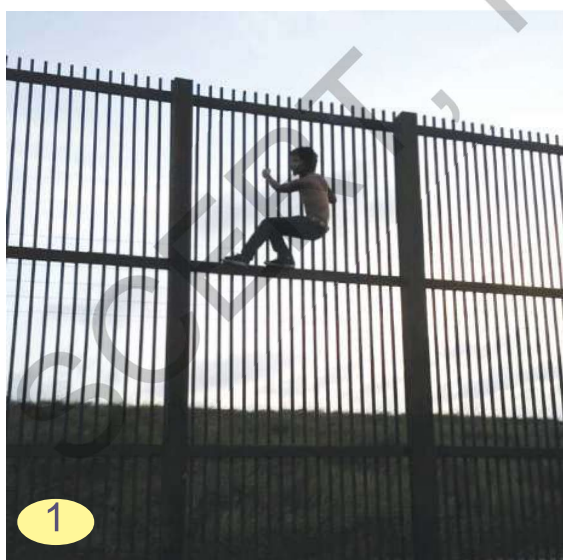


Fig 7.7 : National boundaries are protected against migrants. Here are examples of
1) USA on Mexican border
2) South Korea on North Korean border

3) India on Bangladesh border. What do you think of migrants across the border?



Keywords

1. Settlement
2. Megacities
3. Aerotropolis
4. Urbanisation
5. Metropolitan city
6. Migration
7. Immigration
8. Emigration
9. Seasonal migration
10. Border



Improve your learning



1. What is a settlement?
2. How was human lifestyle changed with settlements?
3. How does the Census of India define various kinds of places? How does it organize them in order of size and other characteristics?
4. What is an aerotropolis? How is it structured?
5. Read the last para of page 100 “When families migrate many of them become dropouts”, and comment on it.
6. Compare and contrast the migration from rural to urban areas and rural to rural areas.
7. Do you think migrants are trouble makers/ trouble shooters in their destinations? Justify your answer.
8. How does rural to urban migration increase the purchasing power of people in rural areas?
9. Why are only professionals able to go to developed countries? Why cannot unskilled workers migrate to these countries?
10. Describe the similarities and differences between the impacts of internal and international migration.
11. Locate the following in the map of India.
a) Chennai b) Bengaluru c) Delhi d) Hyderabad e) Kolkata



Project

Collect Information either from emigrants or Immigrants.

Sl. No.	Emigrant's family head	Total emigrants	Place where they migrated to	Reasons for migration	Conditions at the place	Conditions after migration

After Collecting the information from the families, analyse the situation and find out solutions.

Debate: Is urbanisation a symbol of development or does it lead to problems. Conduct a debate on it.